

The Great Ocean of Dharma: Ten Chapters on the Abiding of the Bodhisattva Mind as Taught by the Buddha Vairocana

Toh 256 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 256 in the Kangyur is a Mahayana scripture known in English as "The Great Ocean of Dharma," spoken by the buddha Vairocana and organized into ten chapters on the abiding of the bodhisattva mind; its Tibetan title is Chos kyi rgya mo. The text opens with a solemn call to assembly in which all children of the buddha are urged to join their palms, confess any transgressions wholeheartedly, and listen as the great moral discipline of all buddhas is expounded. It addresses a broad audience — those of great virtue alongside laymen and laywomen — and its emphasis on confession, purification, and the cultivation of the bodhisattva mind marks it as a work concerned with both ethical conduct and the awakening aspiration central to the Mahayana. The text belongs to the general class of Mahayana sutras within the Kangyur.

The Great Ocean of Dharma. The ten chapters on the abiding of the bodhisattva mind, as taught by the buddha Vairocana. The first section.

All children of the buddha, join your palms and listen from the depths of your heart as the great moral discipline of all buddhas is explained. All those assembled, gather your minds and listen well. If you know that you have transgressions throughout, confess them fully and openly. If you confess, you will be at ease. If you do not confess, on account of that wrongdoing you will be born in the deepest of hells. If you have no transgressions, remain silent without speaking, and all will be recognized as pure.

Those who possess great virtue, as well as laymen and laywomen and others, listen and examine yourselves. Because the buddhas have passed into nirvāṇa, when practicing the Dharma at a stūpa, enter into the discipline of individual liberation and hold it as something weighty, with reverence and as something precious. This is what is called the moral discipline of individual liberation (prātimokṣa). To take up this discipline is like meeting with light out of darkness. It is like a poor person obtaining great wealth. It is like a sick person finding medicine. It is like a prisoner being released from the darkness of a dungeon. It is like a traveler who has gone far along a long road and

returns home again. It is evident that this is the great master of all, and there is nothing that can compare with a buddha who dwells in the world.

The mind of fear is difficult to give rise to, and the mind of virtue is difficult to keep from straying. Therefore, to be dismissive of misdeeds and think them nonexistent — that would be like a small drop of water which, through the continuity of its stream, fills up a great vessel. By committing even a small wrongdoing in just a brief moment, one falls into a hell realm of boundless suffering. If one loses the human body even briefly, one will not obtain the human body again for as many as a thousand eons. When it is flourishing, it does not stay. It is like a horse running at full gallop. Human life, too, has no permanence; it passes faster than the rushing of a swift river. Though alive today, even tomorrow is uncertain. Right now, at this very moment, it is fitting that many of you, each from your own place, gather your minds into one and seek its expression.

With care, do not indulge in laziness, idleness, lying down, or sleeping, sinking into a torpid mind of self-ease. At night, gather the mind and constantly hold the Three Jewels as a protection. Do not occupy yourselves with pointless wandering, wearying yourselves with afflictions, so that in the next life you are filled with deep regret and in the end attain nothing at all. Let many of you pass this discipline on well, one to another.

At that time, Vairocana, for the sake of the multitude, opened the gateway-sūtra of the Dharma, inconceivably vast in number beyond the grains of sand of hundreds of thousands of Ganges rivers, and from within it found the very tip, fine as a hair, of the abiding of the mind. This was taught to all the buddhas of the past as well. To the buddhas of the present it is taught in just the same way. To all the buddhas of the future, it will be taught likewise. The bodhisattvas of the three times have trained, are training, and will train in it. Because I have practiced this abiding of the mind for a hundred eons, my teacher is called the saṃbhogakāya of perfect enjoyment. You, all buddhas, take everything I have taught and, one from another, open the path of the abiding of the mind to all sentient beings.

Then, in the vessel-realm of the Lotus Essence, from upon a lion throne brilliant and gleaming with the radiance of the sky, Vairocana sent forth light, touching the buddhas above the thousand flowers below, saying: Receive and hold the chapters of this gateway of Dharma on the abiding of my mind, and proclaim it now. Again, by the hundreds of trillions of Śākyamunis, passing one

to another, the chapters of the gateway of Dharma on the abiding of the mind up to and including my own were proclaimed to all sentient beings.

"Hold you and the rest together as one mind, and enact it." Then the hundreds of trillions upon trillions of Śākyamunis above the thousand flowers, rising from their brilliant and gleaming lion thrones in the vessel-realm of the Lotus Essence, came forward one by one, made prostrations, and drew back. From their entire bodies they sent forth inconceivable light, and from within that light they brought forth countless buddhas. At once, with countless blue, yellow, red, and white flowers, they made offerings to the buddhas of the saṃbhogakāya (the enjoyment body), and thereafter, having taken fully into themselves the final chapter on the abiding of the mind, they each sank back into the vessel-realm of the Lotus Essence, and by their intrinsic nature sank within the emptiness of a thousand aeons, returning to the place where the meditative absorption of luminous flowers first arose. Then they went to the foot of the awakening tree of Jambudvīpa, and arising from the natural-aeon meditative absorption of luminous flowers, they sat upon the primordial vajra-king's throne and in the mansion of exceedingly fine light, and taught the Dharma equal to the ocean of Dharma in the ten directions.

Then, rising again from the lion throne, they went to the palace of heaven of the Thirty-Three and taught the ten chapters of Dharma in sequence. Then they went to the heaven of Yāma and taught the ten things to be done. Then, rising again from the throne, they went to the heaven of the Four Great Kings and taught the ten views on direction and outlook. Then, rising again from their seat, they went to the heaven of Nirmāṇarati (the Heaven of Delight in Creation) and taught the ten immutable meditative concentrations. Then, rising again from their seat, they went to the heaven of Paranirmitavaśavartin (the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Creations) and taught the Dharma of the ten grounds. Then they went within the first meditative concentration and taught the ten vajras. Then they went within the second meditative concentration and taught the Dharma of the ten chapters on patience. Then they went within the third meditative concentration and taught the ten aspirational prayers. Then they went to the palace of the king of heaven of the great vastness within the fourth meditative concentration — the supreme mastery, the gathering heaven of great extent — and there the buddhas of the saṃbhogakāya of the realm of manifold lotus flowers of my own primordial succession taught the final chapter of the Dharma on the abiding of the mind.

The other hundreds of trillions upon trillions of Śākyamunis were likewise: not two, not different. This is also explained in detail within the chapter of the aeon of meditative concentration.

At that time, Śākyamuni arose from the eastern quarter of the vessel-realm of the Lotus Essence flowers, entered within a floating mansion, and taught as though feeding Dharma to māras. Descending, he was born in Kapila on Jambudvīpa: his mother's name was Mahādevī the Beautiful, his father's name was Śuddhodana, and his own name was Siddhārtha. At the age of seven he went forth into renunciation. At the age of thirty he proceeded to buddhahood, and his name became Śākyamuni. Sitting upon the vajra-flower throne in the pure, immutable place, he went to the palace of the king of heaven of the great lord Indra (Śakra), and there taught in sequence the ten stations of sitting within it.

At that time, the Buddha, so that the king of heaven of the great pure lineage might see the victory banner of the net, taught the countless realms — comparable, for example, to the pores of a net — each realm distinct and different from the next, different and countless. The teaching of the gateways of the Dharma of the buddhas is likewise. I myself have traversed this realm eight thousand times, and for the sake of this realm of Jambudvīpa I sit upon the vajra throne and go to the palace of the king of heaven of the great lord Indra. All the many things within it are the great sūtra on the abiding of the mind.

Then, descending from the heavenly palace, he went to the foot of the Bodhi Tree in Jambudvīpa, and there, upon the ground of that place, for the sake of the foolish and lowly sentient beings of that land, the buddha of the primordial, ultimate saṃbhogakāya (enjoyment body) taught the inner meaning of the abiding of mind. The mind in its primordial, unmoving state is the single code of moral discipline that perpetually shines with luminosity, and it is recited as a chant. The vajra and precious moral discipline is the primordial ultimate of all buddhas. For all bodhisattvas it is the primordial ultimate — the seed of the essential nature of all buddhas. All sentient beings likewise possess the share of the essential nature of buddhahood. All cognition, all color, all mind, mentation, and consciousness without exception are gathered within the essential nature of buddhahood. Within moral discipline there is merit that is permanent and everlastingly constant. Permanently and everlastingly constant, there is the Dharma body. These ten forms of individual liberation arose from the dharmadhātu of the buddhas,

were made into the moral discipline of the Dharma, and are upheld as dhāraṇī by all sentient beings of the three times. For the sake of these many, I have now studied and taught the ten chapters of moral discipline without end or exhaustion.

I, the saṃbhogakāya,
abiding primordially at the center of the lotus,
upon one thousand flowers at the four borders —
one thousand Śākyamunis are seated there.
Each single flower holds ten billion realms,
and each of those realms likewise holds one emanation.
All are seated at the foot of the Bodhi Tree,
all having arrived at the place of equal awakening.
And those ten billion in turn number one thousand —
the saṃbhogakāya, the body of intrinsic nature.
One hundred thousand billion emanations
each guide countless dust-like particles of beings.
All come simultaneously to my abode.
Buddhas, hear my moral discipline!
Then open that gate of fresh butter-milk.
After drinking, one hundred thousand billion
proceed to the pure abode,
all seated at the foot of the Bodhi Tree.
Gather around my preceptor's moral discipline and recite it!
Fifty-eight realizations of great moral discipline —
the brilliance of moral discipline, like sun and moon.
It is as though purchasing a single precious jewel.
Like dust-like particles of bodhisattvas,
through the merit of this, perfect accomplishment arises.
From the very beginning the saṃbhogakāya itself shouldered it,
and I too in the same way took it upon myself to recite.
Newly training bodhisattvas,
carry it upon the crown and maintain the discipline,
and while remaining capable, teach sentient beings together as one.
Always hear my words of ease and comfort.
The Dharma phenomena of the buddhas — moral discipline is their vessel,
individual liberation is like wisdom.
The many have the highest confidence in mind examining all.

You all shall arrive at buddhahood.
Though I have already arrived at buddhahood,
always have confidence in it in this same way.
The chapter of moral discipline is wholly pure and complete.
All that possesses mentation and mind
is entirely gathered in and embraced by the buddha's discipline.
Sentient beings who are embraced by the buddha's discipline
then go to the ground of buddhahood.
Equaling the ground of great sensation,
truly the children of all buddhas —
venerated with respect by the many —
with one mind, disciplined, hear my recitation.

At that time, at the foot of the Bodhi Tree, the primordial buddha Śākyamuni attained the unsurpassed, eternal, perfect awakening. The primordial bodhisattva's observance of individual liberation is to make request to one's father and mother, to the Saṅgha, and to the Three Jewels, and to act without contradiction to mind. Having made request and without contradicting the mind of the teacher — this is the path of attaining the profound Dharma. The name for making request is moral discipline. As a single name, it is vow and giving. Then immeasurable luminosity arises. At that time, vast multitudes of one hundred thousand billion assembled bodhisattvas, and the eighteen heavenly layers of the form realm,

the gods of the six heavenly layers of the desire realm (kāmadhātu), and the great kings all joined their palms together, and with one mind they listened intently, and then took upon themselves the great moral discipline of the buddhas. The Blessed One declared to the bodhisattvas: "I myself at present recite as a liturgical chant the moral discipline of all the buddhas twice each month. You also — all bodhisattvas, beginning with those who have first aroused the mind of awakening — should likewise recite it as a liturgical chant. Let the mind be stirred, and the bodhisattvas of the ten directions, of the ten oscillations and arisings, of the ten vajras, and of the ten grounds — all of them should likewise recite it as a liturgical chant. If they do so, the light of moral discipline arises from the mouth and has a cause. It is not the light that is without condition. It is not blue light, nor red, nor yellow, nor white, nor black; it has no color; it is not mind; it is not existent; it is not nonexistent; it is not a phenomenon of causes and conditions. For all buddhas it is the

primordial origin; for all bodhisattvas it is the very root of the path — it is more than the multitude of all things — and it is called the final root of the sons of the buddhas. In this way, it is the lineage to be held and upheld by dhāraṇī by the sons of the buddhas, and it is the lineage that has been well trained. Sons of the buddhas, listen carefully to this examination. Whoever has received the moral discipline of the buddhas — kings, princes, ministers great and small, monks of either gender, the eighteen heavenly layers of the form realm, the six heavens of the desire realm, outcastes, the lowly, men of loose conduct, women of loose conduct, male and female servants, the eight classes of spirits, those who make obeisance, animals, and people who transform through magical powers — in short, all those who have come into contact with the words and signs of a teacher of Dharma are suitable recipients for the conferral of moral discipline, and all of them are to be called by the utterly pure name.

The Blessed One declared to the sons of the buddhas: "In individual liberation there are ten root defeats. One who has received the moral discipline of the buddhas but does not recite this moral discipline as a liturgical chant is neither a bodhisattva nor a seed of buddhahood. I myself likewise recite it as a chant. I shall teach, in brief, the dhāraṇī sūtra of individual liberation to all bodhisattvas who have completed their training, all bodhisattvas who will train in the future, and all bodhisattvas who are training now, so that they may train in it and hold it by dhāraṇī."

The Blessed One declared to the sons of the buddhas: "One must not intentionally kill any sentient being whatsoever — whether by killing with one's own hand, causing another to kill, remaining among those who kill while watching the killing being done and rejoicing in mind, killing by means of mantra or incantation, being a cause of killing, being a condition of killing, acting in accordance with killing, or performing the act of killing and so forth. For this bodhisattva is perpetually compassionate; the mind of earnest request is great and non-contradictory; always stirring and pervading — such is the lineage suited to serving as a target and refuge for all sentient beings. If one kills a sentient being by one's own hand, out of self-indulgence and to satisfy one's own heart, that is a root defeat for a bodhisattva.

Son of the buddhas, one must not intentionally take what has not been given — whether taking it oneself without it being given, causing another to take without it being given, taking it without it being given by means of a stratagem, being a cause of taking what is not given, being a condition of

taking what is not given, performing the act of taking what is not given, carrying off wealth through mantra or magical illusion, and so forth — not even a needle or a blade of grass that belongs to gods, spirits, or any owner, or that is the wealth and property even of one's own mind, must I intentionally take without its being given. A bodhisattva generates the intrinsic nature of buddhahood, and with a mind of earnest request that is without contradiction —"

with loving-kindness and compassion, ever generating virtue and merit for all sentient beings — this is the proper way. To do the reverse of that, and to take what belongs to human beings without its being given, is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

O child of the buddha, should I engage in unchaste conduct myself, or cause another to engage in unchaste conduct, or engage in unchaste conduct with any woman, or engage in unchaste conduct with another, or be a cause of unchaste conduct, or be a condition of unchaste conduct, or perform the act of unchaste conduct, or carry out the karma of unchaste conduct, or engage in unchaste conduct with animals, or with goddesses, or with the daughters of asuras, or engage in unchaste conduct that is contrary to the Dharma — a bodhisattva, with a mind of earnest request that is without contradiction, should direct all sentient beings toward the arrow-shot of liberation and give them the pure Dharma. This is the proper way. To do the reverse — to arouse unchaste conduct toward any human being, or toward animals, one's mother, one's daughter, one's sister, and so forth, any of the six classes of relatives, and to do so without loving-kindness and compassion — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

O child of the buddha, should I myself speak falsely, or cause another to speak falsely, or speak falsely by a stratagem, or make a cause of falsity, or make a condition of falsity, or perform the act of falsity, or carry out the karma of falsity, or say of what was seen that it was not seen, or say of what was not seen that it was seen, or speak falsely in body and mind — a bodhisattva should ever generate honest speech and, above all, generate honest speech for sentient beings. To do the reverse — to generate dishonest speech for all sentient beings, to engage in crooked views, and to act in crooked ways — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

O child of the buddha, should I myself sell intoxicants, or cause another to sell intoxicants, or sell intoxicants by a stratagem, or make a cause of selling

intoxicants, or make a condition of selling intoxicants, or perform the act of selling intoxicants, or carry out the karma of selling intoxicants, and so forth — it is entirely wrong to sell any intoxicant, for through the condition of intoxicants wrongdoing arises. A bodhisattva, whose proper way is to generate in all sentient beings a wisdom that is lucid and straight, should not, in return, generate a mind of inverted views in all sentient beings — to do so is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

O child of the buddha, should I slander the faults of those who have gone forth, those who have not gone forth, bodhisattvas, monks, and nuns, or cause others to slander them, or make a cause of slander, or make a condition of slander, or perform the act of slander, or carry out the karma of slander — a bodhisattva's proper way is ever to generate compassion and, saying that among those who practise the two lesser vehicles and those who are not following the Buddha's Dharma, certain things are not Dharma and not ethical discipline, to teach and instruct those who are base to delight in and have faith in the Great Vehicle. To do the reverse — if a bodhisattva, in reversal of this, teaches wrong certainty regarding the Buddha's Dharma — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

O child of the buddha, should one praise oneself and disparage others, or teach others to praise oneself and disparage others, or make a cause of disparagement, or make a condition of disparagement, or perform the act of disparagement, or carry out the karma of disparagement — a bodhisattva's proper way is to take upon oneself all the blame of all sentient beings and all that is disagreeable, and to give to others whatever is virtuous and good. Should one instead speak of one's own good qualities, suppress the good qualities of others, and cause others to be disparaged — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

Sons of the buddha, if one is greatly covetous oneself, or shows others how to be greatly covetous, or makes a cause of covetousness, or makes a condition of covetousness, or acts in the manner of covetousness, or performs the karma of covetousness — a bodhisattva's proper way is to give to all who come in poverty whatever they desire. But if, instead, one harbors malice in one's mind toward a bodhisattva, reviles that mind, and when a single poor person comes, or a single needle, or a single blade of grass — one gives nothing; and when someone comes seeking the Dharma, one does not teach even a word, a single chapter, or the slightest particle of Dharma, but instead drives them away with harsh speech and insults — that is a defeat for a

bodhisattva.

Sons of the buddha, if one is angry oneself, or shows an unruly person how to be angry, or makes a cause of anger, or makes a condition of anger, or acts in the manner of anger, or performs the karma of anger — a bodhisattva's proper way is to cultivate wholesome roots in all beings, to act without conflict or dispute, and always to generate compassion. But if, instead, one goes back on that and reviles with harsh words even those among all sentient beings who are not themselves sentient beings — striking them with the hand, cutting and beating them with sword and staff — and one's compassionate love does not diminish; yet when the wrongdoer repents and comes with gentle words, seeking to make amends, one still does not untie the knot of anger — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

Sons of the buddha, if someone speaks denial of the Three Jewels — saying "it is not so" — or teaches others to speak denial of the Three Jewels, or makes a cause or condition of such denial, or acts in the manner of denial, or performs the karma of denial — a bodhisattva's proper way is this: if, while sitting quietly, one hears or sees even a single base and lowly word of abuse — a sound that is not the voice of the buddha, a word of denial — and that is like three hundred triple-pointed spears piercing the heart, how much more so to speak such denial oneself? It is proper rather to give rise to a mind of sincere faith, unwavering and undivided. But if instead one turns back and associates with the perverse and ignoble, looking to them and speaking denial alongside them — that is a defeat for a bodhisattva.

Those who have entered into virtue and conduct should train in this individual liberation (prātimokṣa) of the bodhisattva. If not even the slightest particle of it may be broken, how much less need one speak of breaking all ten rules of moral discipline in their entirety? Should someone break the rules of moral discipline, in the present body one is incapable of performing the work of generating the bodhisattva mind. One loses one's place among kings; one loses one's place among wheel-turning kings; one loses one's place among monks and nuns. The ten qualities of stirring and directing, the ten of generating and beseeching, the ten of being like the vajra of Dharma, and the essential natures of the buddhas of the ten grounds — these are permanent. All such profound qualities and more are utterly lost, and one falls into the three lower realms, where for two or three aeons one does not hear even the names of one's parents or of the Three Jewels. Therefore not even a single rule may be broken.

You and all other bodhisattvas — those who have trained, those who are training, and those who will train — should study these ten rules of moral discipline and practice them with respect, holding them always in mind. A full explanation is given at length in the Eighty Thousand Chapters.

The Buddha declared to the bodhisattvas: The ten defeats have now been explained. As for the forty-eight transgressions, sons of the buddha, these apply when one attains the rank of a king, when one attains the rank of a wheel-turning king, when one attains the rank of a minister, and when one has previously received the bodhisattva moral discipline. All spirits, gods, and demons likewise attend upon and take refuge in the body of a king and the body of a minister. And all buddhas rejoice.

Once one has received the moral discipline, one should generate a mind that does not conflict with the existing order and a mind that holds that order in reverence. When one sees an abbot seated in a high rank, or a teacher, or someone who practices the holy life equally within the Great Vehicle, or someone who holds an equal view, or someone who acts in harmony with the Dharma, one should rise, welcome them, make prostrations, and ask after their health. This is the rule.

If a bodhisattva instead generates a mind of arrogance, a mind of laziness, or a mind of dullness, and does not rise, does not welcome them, does not make prostrations, and does not, in whatever way is fitting and in accordance with the Dharma, use respectful gifts, paintings, one's own body, one's estates, one's residences, the seven precious substances, and all manner of wealth to supply all that is needed — if one is incapable of doing so, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, if anyone deliberately drinks alcohol, the fault of intoxication arises and one loses an incalculable store of wholesome merit. Should someone take up a vessel of alcohol with their own body and hands and offer it to another person to drink, for five hundred lives they will be born without hands — to say nothing of drinking it oneself. Accordingly, it is not permitted to teach any human being or any sentient being to drink alcohol. To say nothing of drinking it oneself: deliberately drinking it and offering it to another is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, it is not permitted to deliberately eat meat, nor to eat any flesh whatsoever. If one eats flesh, the seed of the nature of compassion and loving-kindness is severed, and all sentient beings, seeing one, will flee in fear

and shun one. Therefore a bodhisattva must not eat the flesh of sentient beings. To eat flesh is an immeasurable sin. If one eats flesh, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, the five pungent plants must not be eaten. These are garlic, chives, leeks, wild onions, and asafoetida. These five must not be eaten in any food whatsoever. If anyone eats them deliberately, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, whenever one sees any sentient being who has broken the eight precepts, the five precepts, or the ten precepts, or who has broken the four root precepts, the seven inversions, or the discipline of the eight offenses, one should direct them to make confession and purification. If a bodhisattva fails to instruct them and does not cause them to make confession and purification, then when the Saṅgha who live together and practice the holy life equally are gathered as one and the Dharma is being recited, one must cause anyone who has actually committed a fault to make confession and purification of that offense. If one does not cause them to do so, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, when one sees an abbot who holds the view of the Great Vehicle together with oneself and acts together with oneself, and who has come to the Saṅgha's residence or to one's home, one should go out to welcome them at a distance of a thousand arrow-shots if they are approaching, and should escort them when they are departing, and make prostrations. One should show them honor and gifts, and offer gifts three times each day and at the three times of day. Each day one should supply food worth three measures of gold, a proper seat, and whatever the Dharma teacher desires, supplying it all and providing it. Always attend upon the Dharma teacher, request Dharma teachings at the three times of day, and each day at the three times offer prostrations respectfully, generating neither a mind of anger nor a mind of grief. For the sake of the Dharma, dedicate even one's body and request the Dharma. If one does not do so, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, wherever there is a great establishment that upholds moral discipline and the sūtras, and within which Dharma is being taught, a newly training bodhisattva should carry the volume of the moral discipline texts, go to where the Dharma teacher resides, and make requests, inquiring and reflecting on the teaching. Some go to mountains, forests, the foot of

trees, Saṅgha grounds, homes, and every place where the Dharma is taught, having made an offering, and they listen and do whatever is desired.

If one goes to that place but does not listen and does not reflect, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, if one's mind is contrary to the Great Vehicle, yet one constantly dwells in the writings and moral discipline of the buddhas, and when something is spoken aloud one says, "That was not taught by the buddha," and one constantly regards the two divisions of the Lesser Vehicle as definitive, and upholds the moral discipline and Dharma writings of those who hold wrong views entirely — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, all those who are struck by illness should constantly be attended and cared for, and be treated as equal to a buddha. Among the eight categories of virtuous merit, the virtuous merit of looking after and caring for the sick is the highest of all merits. Parents, preceptors, the Saṅgha, disciples, and all those who are struck by any illness — whether of faculties that are incomplete or of afflictions — should all be cared for and brought to recovery.

With respect to this, if a bodhisattva looks upon sentient beings with hostility and ill will and does not go to Saṅgha households or to many districts and towns, or to valleys, mountain gorges, fortresses, and groves where sick people are dwelling, and does not offer swift assistance and proper care, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, swords, bows and arrows, spears, axes, and the like — weapons fit for combat — as well as traps and snares and similar implements for killing sentient beings, are not to be carried. For a bodhisattva, even if one's own parents are killed by others, one does not take revenge in kind; how much less could one kill all sentient beings? To carry weapons openly and deliberately is a transgression.

These ten precepts of moral discipline are to be trained in and are appropriate to be held constantly as one's guiding rules. They are explained at length in the six chapters below.

The buddha then declared to the sons of the buddha: Sons of the buddha, if out of desire for gain one harbors an evil intention and sends messengers into foreign lands, arrays troops for battle, raises an army, and fights, killing many sentient beings — then for a bodhisattva to enter into such an army and wander back and forth among the soldiers is itself inappropriate; how much

more so deliberately to make enemies of an entire region? To do so deliberately is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, trading in subordinates and servants, trading in male slaves and the like, dealing in livestock of the six kinds, and engaging in commerce involving coffins and corpses and their containers — these are activities that one ought not to do oneself; how much less should one instruct others to do them? To do so deliberately is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, if one arises with an evil intent and falsely accuses those who are pure in virtue and discipline — Dharma preceptors who are clearly virtuous, heads of Saṅgha communities, kings, and noble and venerable persons — saying that they have committed the seven reversals, the ten root downfalls, and have broken the moral discipline toward parents, elder and younger siblings, and the six categories of kin, in a manner contrary to what is true, rather than with the spirit of loving-kindness and compassion — if one thereby generates the harm of turning others against them and they fall into a place of misfortune, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, if one arises with an evil intent and deliberately sets great fires, burning mountains, groves, valleys, and mountain gorges from the first month of summer to the end of the last month of autumn — or if some deliberately set fires and burn others' houses, fortresses, villages, Saṅgha residences, fields, orchards, shrines of gods and spirits, and all the goods and property of those who have owners — this is not permitted. For those who do so deliberately, that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, it is appropriate to instruct all of one's own disciples in the buddha's teaching, those who are companions in practice, the six categories of kin, and all spiritual friends, so that they may take up, uphold, and hold to the writings and moral discipline of the Great Vehicle. One should understand both the scriptural tradition and the established system, and teach the ten minds of the bodhisattva — the arousing of the awakening mind, the sustained arousing, and the beseeching mind —

the vajra-mind of Dharma should be demonstrated as something to be stirred up, and one should understand the proper sequence from one to the next and the ritual procedures of the Dharma.

When a bodhisattva gives rise to ill will and aversion toward another bodhisattva, and then teaches that other person the moral discipline, writings, sitting in silence, and teachings of wrong view belonging to the two lesser

vehicles of the śrāvakas — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, with a virtuous mind, one should first study the armor, moral discipline, and writings of the Great Vehicle in their fullness, taste the flavor of the texts to whatever degree is possible, and then, upon seeing a newly training bodhisattva who has come from a distance of a hundred or a thousand leagues, desiring the writings and moral discipline of the Great Vehicle, it is appropriate to teach the Dharma correctly, practicing austerity for the sake of the Dharma. By "austerity" is meant burning the body, burning the arm, and burning the fingers.

In this regard, if one burns one's body, arm, or fingers without offering that as a gift to all the buddhas, then that ordained bodhisattva is not truly a bodhisattva. For tigers, wolves, lions overcome by hunger, and all manner of hungry spirits and the like, one should be willing to give the flesh and limbs of one's body, and having given them, one should then teach the genuine Dharma in proper sequence from beginning to end, so as to open the mind and turn the intellect. In this regard, it is not appropriate to demand repayment in order to gain the benefit of being repaid by those bodhisattvas. To misrepresent the writings and moral discipline, to distort the words, and then without distinction to slander and defame the Three Jewels — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, for the sake of food, wealth, benefit, or a good reputation, calling kings, princes, great ministers, and the like "friend" — flattering them and forcibly demanding wealth from them, intimidating them with harsh words to forcibly seek wealth and profit — to pursue in every case a multitude of evil things for the sake of names is what is called "being many who pursue the evil." To demonstrate to others that there is no compassion and no arising of a mind that is not opposed to flattery — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, when one is learning to recite the moral discipline by heart, once a day and at the six time periods one should take up the bodhisattva's moral discipline, and one should understand the text and its meaning as the very nature of buddha. For a bodhisattva to say, claiming it as a phrase of magic, that one is capable without knowing even a single word or a single chapter on the qualities of moral discipline — this is to despise and deceive oneself, and to despise others as well. To know not a single aspect of all the Dharma, yet to act as preceptor for others and to teach moral discipline — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, with ill will aroused, carrying a begging bowl in hand — the virtuous hand that holds moral discipline — upon seeing one performing the works of a bodhisattva, to interrupt between the two parties and to slander the noble person by saying "He does nothing but despise and harm," and to deliberately do likewise — that is a transgression.

Sons of the buddha, one should practice compassion and engage in the work of releasing beings without killing anything whatsoever. All males are my fathers; all females are my mothers. In every birth I have taken throughout all my previous lifetimes, there is none of them from whom I was not born. Therefore the sentient beings of the six destinies are my fathers and mothers. To kill and eat them would be to kill my own parents. In another sense, it would be to kill my old body. All earth and water are my former bodies. All fire and wind are the later forms of my physical form. Therefore one should always engage in the work of releasing living beings, and whenever and wherever one sees beings being killed, one should employ skillful means — creating with one's own nets, cages, bows, and arrows of compassion a broad expanse, so as to liberate those tormented by afflictions and driven to poverty. Always teach the bodhisattva's moral discipline, and

teach them so that they become a fence and arrows of liberation for sentient beings. When a father, mother, or elder or younger brother dies, on that very day one should seek out a Dharma preceptor and have the bodhisattva's moral discipline explained. Through the merit of this, the deceased will meet all the buddhas and be reborn in the higher realms. If one does not do so, it is a transgression.

The Dharma Ocean, second and final section.

It is as follows. If one trains in these ten precepts of moral discipline, it is fitting to receive them while holding one's mind in reverence. Within the chapter on the cleansing of wrongdoing, the single discipline of moral discipline alone is explained broadly and clearly from one to the next.

The buddhas declared to the children of the buddhas: one does not repay anger with anger; one does not repay blows with blows. Even if one's father, mother, elder or younger brothers, and all six kinds of kin have been killed, it is not permissible to take revenge. Even if another has killed one's own king, it is not permissible to take revenge. To take revenge while taking life is contrary to the Dharma of consecration. To scold a servant with harsh words, to beat him, and to commit the three kinds of negative action for even a single day

already incurs countless misdeeds — how much more need be said of one who deliberately performs the seven-fold wrong of seven reversals! Not to have compassion for a renunciant bodhisattva, and to deliberately take revenge against one's six kinds of kin and the like — that is a transgression.

If a child of the buddhas has gone forth for the very first time and, knowing nothing whatsoever, fancies himself sharp in faculties and wise — and some, puffed up with pride, fancy themselves aged in years and well-established; some are proud of great family and high connections; some are proud of great learning; some of great authority; some of possessing many of the seven precious substances — and on account of such arrogance and conceit does not ask or receive Dharma teachings and moral discipline from a preceptor who has understood the Dharma before — even though some preceptors of the Dharma may be of modest standing, some younger in years, some of limited means, some poor, and some incomplete in faculties, yet may have fine Dharma learning in solitude and have exhausted all Dharma texts and moral discipline — then that newly training bodhisattva, if, out of ignorance and looking always to opportunity in method, does not come to the preceptor of the Dharma to ask and receive the entire corpus of the genuine truth, it is a transgression.

If a child of the buddhas, after a buddha has passed, desires and receives the moral discipline of the buddhas with a virtuous mind, he should make a firm commitment in his own mind before an image of a buddha and a bodhisattva, and for up to seven days he should make full confession before the buddha. If he sees an auspicious sign, he has obtained the precepts. If he does not see an auspicious sign, he should continue for a second week of seven days, a third week, up to a full year, receiving the precepts by the warmth of seeing an auspicious sign. When he has seen an auspicious sign, he receives the moral discipline before an image of a buddha and a bodhisattva. If he has not seen an auspicious sign, even if he receives the moral discipline before an image of a buddha and a bodhisattva, it may not be said that he has "obtained the precepts" even in name. However, if someone receives the precepts in the presence of one who has already conferred the bodhisattva moral discipline before, no auspicious sign is needed. Why so? Because it is transmitted from one preceptor of the Dharma to the next, no auspicious sign is required; if one receives the moral discipline in the presence of that Dharma preceptor, one also obtains the moral discipline, and a mind of reverence arises. If there is no preceptor capable of conferring the moral discipline within a range of a

thousand leagues, and one receives the precepts before an image of a buddha and a bodhisattva, then one must see an auspicious sign.

If some Dharma preceptor who knows the texts and moral discipline of the Great Vehicle, and who fancies himself beloved and close to kings, princes, and ministers — and when a newly training bodhisattva comes to inquire into the method of Dharma texts and to ask the standard questions on moral discipline, that preceptor, with a mind of contempt, an ill will, or a mind of laziness, does not give answers to even one who comes asking one by one — that is a transgression.

O child of the Buddha, those who are unable to train in and practice the Dharma texts and moral discipline of the Buddha — the upright Dharma of the Great Vehicle, the seeing of what is upright, the essential nature of uprightness, and the body of upright Dharma — through diligence: having abandoned seven sets of the Seven Jewels and turned back, if they train in clinging to the two divisions of the Lesser Vehicle, the Dharma of stagnant sitting, the texts of inferior tradition, the study of Abhidharma teaching, the texts of the Lesser Vehicle, and to dwelling in those — then, because the seed of the essential nature of buddha is cut, and because they are obscured by the obstruction that blocks the path, this becomes the cause and condition that is not the bodhisattva's path. To do so deliberately is a transgression.

O child of the Buddha: after a buddha has passed, one who acts as master of Dharma exposition, one who acts as householder of the Saṅgha, one who acts as master of teaching and miraculous display, one who acts as master of entering meditative concentration, one who acts as master of coming and going — if one acts in such ways without generating a mind of loving-kindness, then it is fitting to bring together quarrels and disputes into virtue. The wealth of the Three Jewels is to be guarded virtuously and not used inappropriately; one should treat it as equal to wealth that has come through one's own door. If one engages in many wrong actions in that regard with effort, and uses the wealth of the Three Jewels with a mind of self-indulgence, that is a transgression.

O child of the Buddha: if one formerly dwelt within the Saṅgha's household and then, as a bodhisattva and as one who invited monks, later becomes master of the Saṅgha's houses and towers, villages, royal residences, and the proper conduct of the rains retreat, and when one sees a bodhisattva or a monk who has been invited arriving within the assembly, the Saṅgha already dwelling

there should go out to receive those arriving and escort those departing, and should provide and offer fitting hospitality with food, housing, bedding, seats, and all manner of furnishings. If some have no wealth, they should sell their own bodies, their sons, and their daughters and provide whatever is desired, offering everything. If a certain donor comes seeking the Saṅgha in general and seeking to invite a member of the Saṅgha, with merit-offerings to be allocated, the householder master of the Saṅgha should in order send stewards to invite those members of the Saṅgha. But if the Saṅgha was already seated there and he goes claiming stewardship for himself alone and does not send for the invited Saṅgha member, then the householder master of the Saṅgha incurs measureless sins and is comparable to an animal. He is neither a true renunciant nor even a seed of the Śākya lineage. To act in such a way is a transgression.

O child of the Buddha: whatever does not come to one in proper sequence of turn must not be received separately as an offering and claimed for oneself. Offering-goods and materials of that kind are under the authority of the Saṅgha of the ten directions. To set them aside and take them away — to carry off to one's own door wealth belonging to the Saṅgha of the ten directions — and to use for oneself the goods belonging to the eight categories of merit, to the buddhas, to noble ones, to preceptors, to the Saṅgha, to one's parents, and to the sick: that is a transgression.

O child of the Buddha: when a bodhisattva donor — whether ordained or not ordained — seeks out the Saṅgha in order to generate merit and offer aspirational prayers, and upon entering the Saṅgha's domain inquires of the steward-monk as to whose turn falls today, and seeks out that one: then one attains the Saṅgha of miraculous power of the ten directions. By contrast, to separately seek out an arhat, a bodhisattva, or fifty members of the Saṅgha is less meritorious than to seek out in proper sequence of turn a single ordinary member of the Saṅgha. To seek out a different member of the Saṅgha other than that is the Dharma of inferior stagnation. With regard to the seven buddhas, there is no Dharma of seeking out separately.

To seek out the Saṅgha by bypassing the proper procedure of inquiry, going around it — that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who, with an evil intention, lives by the trade of a male medium for the sake of profit from divination — boasting of himself and feeding off it, thrashing himself, assembling men to read the signs of a male

medium, telling those who come about good and bad dreams saying "male" or "female," claiming to fabricate mantras and magic of wrong doctrine of his own devising, performing the rites of an enemy-training doctrine, compounding and applying all manner of poisons — serpent venom, the poison of gold and silver not yet tamed, blight-curses and the like, things utterly devoid of compassion — if he does all this deliberately, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who, with an evil intention, uses his own body to disparage the Three Jewels, and then speaks deceptive flattery to others — preaching emptiness with his mouth while performing the deeds of one who believes in karma, playing the flatterer with ordinary women and men and engaging in unchaste conduct, fearing nothing and having no restraint, holding feast-offerings at the six periods of the day and holding feast-offerings again every three months of the year, killing sentient beings at those times, stealing and robbing, and violating the moral discipline of the feast-offering — that is a transgression.

These ten precepts of moral discipline are proper to be learned and constantly maintained in memory. They are also extensively explained in the chapter on upholding discipline.

The Buddha declared: A child of the Buddha — in the evil age following the passing of the Buddha, when there are wicked times, when there are only wicked people — upon seeing great thieves sell images resembling the Buddha and bodhisattvas as though they were parents, seeing Dharma and texts of moral discipline being sold, seeing monks and nuns being sold, or seeing bodhisattvas who have generated the awakening mind sincerely being sold, and some of them dispatched to perform works of compassion and then made into male and female slaves: a bodhisattva who sees such things should generate a mind of loving-kindness, and by means of skillful ransom and taking them under protection should, in each place where they are lodged, re-teach and instruct them all. All images of buddhas and bodhisattvas, monks and nuns, Dharma texts and texts of moral discipline — if he has wealth, he should ransom them with wealth. If he fails to do so in this way, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha is not permitted to carry weapons such as swords and arrows and bows; nor to engage in trade using false measures, carrying large or small weights and measures that deceive; nor to take wealth from others

out of arrogance; nor to harbor envy toward sentient beings and bind and chain those who have turned against him; nor, while something of value has been entrusted to him, to keep cats, weasels, dogs, pigs, and birds — these he may not keep or tend. If he tends such things deliberately, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who generates an evil intention should not look upon fights among male mediums and the like — battles of armies and great enmities and so forth — as something to be watched. Likewise, he may not blow the conch horn, nor listen to drums and flutes, lutes, zithers, bamboo flutes, mouth organs, singing, or the sound of music. He may not play at dice, nor games of strategy, nor game-board games, nor mock battles of rams, yaks, and sheep, nor wrestling matches among boys, nor stone-throwing contests, nor shooting pellets at pots, nor engage in gambling, nor look at mirror-gazing. He may not divine using the joints of the body, shoulder bones, bowls turned upside down, human skulls, or such things. He may not perform even a single duty as messenger for the sake of a thief's band or the like. If he does all these things deliberately, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who has undertaken to hold the precepts of moral discipline: with respect to the manner of going about, sleeping, sitting, and rising —

Reciting the rules of moral discipline during the six periods of day and night is like a vajra. It is like crossing a great ocean with a raft. In brief, it is like a monk bound by grass. One should constantly cultivate a mind of virtue and confidence in the Great Vehicle, thinking to oneself: "I am a buddha who has not yet reached buddhahood. The children of the buddhas are buddhas who have reached buddhahood." Having aroused the mind of awakening in this way, one should contemplate it uninterruptedly in the mind. If even for a single instant one turns the mind toward the two lesser vehicles or sits in indifference, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha should always offer all aspirational prayers, and should aspire, with a mind of genuine accord, toward one's parents, one's preceptor, the Saṅgha, and the Three Jewels, showing them great respect. One should always aspire to meet a learned preceptor and spiritual friend equal in pure conduct, and always aspire to oneself know and practise according to the Dharma the texts and precepts of the Great Vehicle, the ten extensive and outreaching ones, the ten that give rise to and sustain, the ten that are like the

Dharma-vajra, and the ten grounds and so forth. If any bodhisattva fails to arouse such aspiration, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who has undertaken the precepts of moral discipline and wishes to endure them should contemplate in the mind, without interruption even to the level of the mind's own reflection, that body and life alike are to be relinquished. Concerning this: if any bodhisattva fails to arouse such aspiration, that is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha, after making the ten great aspirational prayers, should take up the precepts of the Buddha as a dhāraṇī and apply the aspiration exactly as follows.

One aspires: even should this body be burned within a great fire, or go upon a mountain of sword-blades, may one never, to the end of time, break the written word of the holy Dharma of the buddhas of the three times, nor the precepts — that they be never destroyed, never destroyed — and may one not be like all women and such, doing these things.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should this body be wrapped about with nets of burning iron and such, layer upon layer, a thousand in succession, may one, in the end, with a body from which moral discipline has not been stripped away, never wear any of the robes of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should burning iron lumps pour down into this mouth like fire and water, flowing in, for a hundred thousand aeons and more, may one, with a mouth in which moral discipline has been destroyed, never eat any of the food of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should this body be laid upon a net of iron heated by great fire, or upon the burning heat of scorching iron, may one, with a body from which moral discipline has been stripped away, never sit upon the seats and cushions of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should this body be pierced by three hundred triple-pointed spear-tips for the space of one or two aeons, may one, in the end, with a body in which moral discipline is destroyed, never eat any of the medicines and remedies of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should this body be placed inside a great boiling cauldron of burning iron for the space of a thousand aeons, may one, in the end, with a body from which moral discipline has been stripped away, never dwell in any of the houses, buildings, gardens, parks, or fields of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should this body be pounded from head to foot with iron hammers until it becomes like fine dust, may one, with a body and mind from which the precepts have been stripped away, never receive the respectful and devoted prostrations of faithful patrons of generosity.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should a hundred thousand burning iron swords and —

— spears piercing and gouging out both eyes, may one, with a mind from which moral discipline has been stripped away, never look upon the beautiful colors of the world beyond.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should a hundred thousand iron needles be inserted for one or two aeons into the pores of the body and into the roots of the ears, may one, with a mind from which the precepts have been stripped away, never listen to sweet music.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should, for a hundred thousand aeons, the nose be cut and the cheeks sliced away by a sword, may one, with a mind from which the precepts have been stripped away, never smell any fragrance whatsoever.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should, for a hundred thousand aeons, the tongue be cut and hacked with a sword, may one, with a mind from which the precepts have been stripped away, never eat any of the pure and wholesome food of human beings.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: even should the body be cut and hacked with sharp axes, may one, with a mind from which the precepts have been stripped away, never crave or cling to pleasant sensations of touch.

And in another single aspiration one aspires as follows: may all sentient beings become buddhas.

If a bodhisattva does not give rise to aspirations such as these, it is a transgression.

A son of the buddhas who is a practitioner of trained virtues, who trains without interruption in both seasons, engages in meditative concentration in winter and summer, enters into moral discipline at the restoration ceremony, and makes use of the following: a wooden scraper, ground grain, the three Dharma robes, pills, an alms bowl, a sitting mat, a strainer, a pouch, a water filter, a hand-cloth, a knife, fire-sticks, a fire-board, medicinal thorns, a low rope-bed, a wooden beam, the rule, and the precepts — such a practitioner of trained virtues must never be separated from the eighteen requisites while living in and traveling between villages, going and coming, even a distance of a hundred thousand arrow-shots. The practitioner of trained virtues observes this from the fifteenth day of the first spring month to the fifteenth day of the last spring month, and from the fifteenth day of the middle autumn month to the ninth day of the first winter month — two seasons during which the eighteen requisites must not be separated from the body, just as a bird is never separated from its wings.

On the day of the restoration ceremony, newly training bodhisattvas should, reciting together, chant aloud by heart, twice a month, the discipline of the ten root defeats and the forty-eight transgressions. When the precepts are being recited, it should be done in the physical presence of images of all buddhas and all bodhisattvas, or in the presence of painted representations of them, with one person leading the recitation and another performing the full confession — whether one, two, or any number, up to a hundred thousand, the recitation is nonetheless led by a single person. The one who leads the recitation sits in a high seat, and those who listen sit in lower seats. From each one's own portion, robes of nine, five, or seven sections of cloth are distributed and one enters into the rule in order from one to the next according to the Dharma.

When practicing the trained virtues, do not enter into places where there are obstacles and danger. Places with obstacles of the district, with hostile kings, with high and low terrain, with deep thickets, or in summer, with lions, tigers, and wolves, or with water, wind, obstacles, bandits and robbers, or roads with venomous serpents and so forth — wherever any such obstacle exists, a practitioner of trained virtues must not travel there. If one goes there deliberately, it is a transgression.

Sons of the buddhas, arrange yourselves in sequence according to this Dharma. One who received moral discipline earlier should sit in front; one who

received moral discipline later should sit behind. Without regard to age — whether fully ordained monks or fully ordained nuns, noble ones, the venerable, kings and princes, ministers, or servants and so on — one who received moral discipline earlier should sit in front.

One who received moral discipline later should sit behind, in proper sequence. Sitting in a disorderly huddle, as fools do — whether old or young — without regard to who came earlier or later, with no proper sequence, is the way of servants and slaves. In my Dharma of the buddhas, the one who came earlier sits in front, and the one who came later sits behind. If a bodhisattva fails to take his seat in proper Dharmic sequence, it is a transgression.

Sons of the buddhas, you should at all times guide and reform every sentient being; build residences for the Saṅgha; construct shrine houses for representations of the buddhas in mountains, groves, enclosures, and fields; and in summer and winter establish places for the practice of ethical conduct and meditative concentration, and arrange for the installation of clean, proper facilities.

Regarding this: when a bodhisattva, for the sake of all sentient beings, recites and teaches the texts of the Great Vehicle Dharma and the codes of moral discipline — if illness arises, or there are obstacles from the region, obstacles from enemies, or if it is the day of the first death of a father or mother, an elder brother or younger brother, an abbot, or the like; or on the seventh, fourteenth, twenty-first, or forty-ninth day after such a death — then for that person's sake one should recite and explain the texts of the Great Vehicle and the moral discipline, perform an offering feast, and pray that they obtain the merit of virtue.

Whether one is coming or going, those engaged in creating merit in this life who are struck by great fire, swept away by great flood, whose vessels are driven down by great black wind, who face enemies on rivers and great lakes, and so on — all those who encounter hindrances from evil, the seven heinous acts (anantarya), eight obstacles, who fall bound at wrist and ankle, who are tightly bound with iron chains to their bodies, who are distressed and greatly angry, who are dull and greatly stupid, or who are beset by the enemy of many illnesses — for all of these, one should take up the recitation of the texts of Great Vehicle Dharma and moral discipline, and explain and teach them.

If a newly training bodhisattva fails to act in this way, it is a transgression.

Study these nine rules of moral discipline and hold them always with reverence. They are also set forth extensively and in detail in the chapter on the teaching of the level of equanimity.

The buddhas declared to the sons of the buddhas: Sons of the buddhas, when conferring moral discipline upon a person, one must not discriminate or be selective. Kings and princes, great ministers and ordinary ministers, fully ordained monks and fully ordained nuns, male and female lay practitioners, men and women of low station, the eight heavenly classes of the form realm, the six heavens of the desire realm, those without faculties, those with both faculties, the humble, male slaves and the like, gods, and demons (asuras) — all of these are fit to receive the vow.

Those who wear Dharma robes upon their bodies should dye them to display changed color, making them accord with the Dharma. Yellow, blue, black, and red — as well as bedding garments and so on — should all have their colors changed. All robes worn on the body should be dyed and their color changed. Among all regions, with regard to the garments worn by human beings, the robes of fully ordained monks are not in harmony with the ordinary garments of worldly folk.

When conferring moral discipline for the first time, the abbot should ask: "Have you committed the seven evil transgressions in this life?" A Dharma abbot who is a bodhisattva must not confer moral discipline upon one who has committed the seven transgressions.

The seven transgressions are as follows: drawing blood from the body of a buddha; killing one's father, one's mother, one's abbot, or one's teacher; violating the purity of the moral discipline of the body; and killing a noble one (ārya) who has set the wheel of Dharma turning. One who has committed all seven of these in their complete form, in the manner of one so obscured, must not be given moral discipline. All others, however, are fit to receive moral discipline.

The rule of one who has gone forth in renunciation is that they do not bow to kings, nor bow to fathers or mothers, nor show deference to the six classes of relatives, nor bow to gods and demons.

If there is someone seeking to receive moral discipline, a Dharma preceptor who is a bodhisattva must not give rise to a malicious or wrathful mind. If such a preceptor fails to give moral discipline to all sentient beings who come, it is a transgression.

If a Dharma preceptor who teaches moral discipline to others wishes to draw in a student by presenting a treatise so as to inspire trusting confidence in a child of the Buddha, and then sees someone approaching to receive moral discipline, let that preceptor first send for the abbot and the teacher. Both the abbot and the teacher must then ask that person whether they bear any of the seven obscuring offenses. If in this very lifetime the person bears an offense obscured by the seven, the abbot must not give moral discipline. If they bear no offense obscured by the seven, they are fit to receive moral discipline.

If someone has broken any of the ten aspects of moral discipline, let them perform full confession and purification. In the presence of a buddha and a bodhisattva, for six sessions day and night, they must take up the recitation of the ten defeats and the forty-eight transgressions as a liturgy, and then pay full homage from the heart to the buddhas of the three times, and in doing so they must witness a good omen. For this they must see a good omen within seven days, or fourteen days, or twenty-one days, or up to one year. A good omen means this: a buddha comes and anoints the crown of the head, and one sees light; or one sees flowers; or one sees any other good omen of whatever kind. The moment such a good omen is seen, the offense is expelled. If no good omen appears, the confession and purification, even though performed, is of no benefit, and at that point one cannot receive moral discipline through the physical body. One should continue for as long as the years and days indicate, pressing on with diligence, and when signs of light appear, one is then fit to receive moral discipline.

For some, the breaking of the forty-eight transgressions is purified the very moment full confession is performed, and is not comparable to being obscured by the seven. Therefore, among the preceptors who teach moral discipline, let one who, even within this Dharma, has proceeded step by step with discretion serve as preceptor. If a preceptor does not know the texts of the Great Vehicle, the lightness and heaviness of moral discipline, the sacred form of what is and what is not, then the supreme truth of the texts, the seed of the prior intrinsic nature, the intrinsic nature of what is presently generated and sustained, the intrinsic nature of what is not ultimately destroyed, the intrinsic nature of the seed of Dharma, the intrinsic nature of what is straight, the intrinsic nature of realization and discernment within all that, and the branches of the ten outer and inner meditative absorptions and so forth — let such a one work by means of the Dharma teachings.

If one has not thoroughly internalized this liturgy, moral discipline, and these Dharma texts step by step, and a bodhisattva, seeking profit through deceit and desiring a fine reputation, covets gain from students, seeks out the wicked, and then declares to those who do not know that one knows all of the Dharma and the texts of moral discipline as though by magic — deceiving and disparaging oneself, the recipient of offerings, and beyond that deceiving and disparaging others as well — then giving moral discipline to someone in that manner is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha who, for the sake of profit from the laity, sits face to face before those who have not yet received the bodhisattva's moral discipline: it is not fitting to teach this great moral discipline of a thousand buddhas before the base-born; it is not fitting to teach it before those who hold wrong views; and it is not fitting to teach it before anyone other than a king. Those wicked persons who have not received the moral discipline of a buddha are called by name the destitute wanderers. Wherever they may be reborn, they do not see the Three Jewels; they are comparable to rocks and wood; they are without mind; their name is "Dharma perverted." Those who hold to perversion are comparable to a block of wood.

If a bodhisattva explains and teaches the moral discipline of the seven most excellent buddhas before such wicked ones, it is a transgression.

If a child of the Buddha has trusting confidence and goes forth in renunciation, one who has sincerely received the profound moral discipline of a buddha and has deliberately aroused the mind of aspiration — if such a one then shatters the noble moral discipline, it is not fitting for them to accept offerings from any patron whatsoever. In the extreme case, they are not even fit to travel along a road within the kingdom, nor even to drink water belonging to the king. Five thousand great demonic spirits perpetually bar their way before them, crying out: "A great enemy has entered the household, the fortress, and the village!" Those spirits then sweep the trail behind the person as they go. The people of the world, though they say, "This one is going about within the Buddha's Dharma," are displeased even to see them. One who has shattered the moral discipline is comparable to an animal, comparable to a block of wood. If one destroys the moral discipline of rectitude, it is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha should make the mind utterly resolute, holding the discipline constantly as a support (dhāraṇī) and reciting it aloud as a chant. One should skin oneself and make paper of it; draw out one's own blood and

use it as ink; break one's own bones and fashion them into a reed pen — and with these write out the letters of the moral discipline of the buddha. One should also write it on tree bark and on white skulls. Then constantly fashioning a case and a vessel of the seven precious substances, of priceless incense, of flowers, and of various jewels, one places inside the written Dharma, the volume of the moral discipline. If one does not adorn it with images in the manner of the Dharma, it is a transgression.

A child of the Buddha, constantly arousing a vast mind, should travel throughout towns, fortresses, and every house. Upon seeing any sentient being, it is fitting to enjoin them: "You and all other sentient beings — turn toward the Three Jewels and receive the ten precepts of moral discipline." Even in the realm of animals, one should speak this in the mind as an aspiration, thinking: "May you, though an animal, arouse the mind of a bodhisattva." A bodhisattva who fails to teach and reform sentient beings commits a transgression.

A child of the Buddha must constantly arouse great compassion for those who are taught and reformed, practicing the Dharma. It is not fitting, while practicing the Dharma, to stand among a large gathering of nobles and patrons and the like wearing grey robes and teach the Dharma. Rather, when one who wears grey robes teaches the Dharma before a large assembly, the Dharma master should be seated on an elevated seat, honored with incense and flowers, while those who listen are arranged humbly around the four sides and attend reverently. One should show respect to the Dharma just as a student renders respectful service to an abbot and does not contradict a father and mother. One should show respect just as the brahmin Agnihotra (the fire-keeper) shows respect while performing the Dharma. If, failing to do likewise, the teacher of the Dharma does not teach in accordance with the Dharma, it is a transgression.

Children of the Buddha, let everyone receive the moral precepts with an undoubting mind. If a king, a prince, or the fourfold assembly of disciples, puffed up with arrogance and conceited about their own high standing, shatters the Dharma and moral discipline of the buddha, stubbornly engages in this as if practicing Dharma, and does not permit one's own fourfold assembly of disciples to go forth in renunciation and practice the Dharma — to obstruct in this extreme way the raising of images of the buddha and the building of stūpas, and to prevent the Dharma and moral discipline from being committed to writing — this is destruction of the Three Jewels. To deliberately

destroy the Dharma in such a fashion is a transgression.

Children of the Buddha, go forth in renunciation with a mind of virtue! If, for the sake of a fine reputation and a good name, or for the advantage of one's livelihood, one teaches the moral discipline of the seven buddhas before kings and ministers, and then improperly bestows the bodhisattva precepts on monks and fully ordained nuns, binding the disciples with fetters — this is like a parasitic worm dwelling on the body of a lion and the lion being eaten by it from within. It is not the case that the lion is eaten by a worm from without.

Therefore, children of the Buddha, sit still and be at peace! It is not the māras who destroy the Dharma — it is we ourselves who destroy the Dharma. If one undertakes the moral discipline of the buddhas, then the care and tending of that moral discipline should be like the thought a father and mother have toward their only child. It should be like a son or daughter making supplication to a father and mother. Sit still and be at peace!

If a wicked person, with evil speech and harmful words, denigrates the moral discipline of the buddhas, that is to be regarded as equal to having three hundred triple-pointed spears thrust into one's heart, or to having one's body beaten a thousand times with a thousand swords and a thousand clubs. I would rather have my own body journey to the hells for a hundred eons than hear even a single evil word spoken against the moral discipline of the buddhas — this is my aspiration. To say nothing of the case of one who has broken the moral discipline oneself and yet reproaches others for it, and who then, step by step, teaches others to break the moral discipline as well — such a one has no mind concordant with the proper entreaties. To act in such a way is a transgression.

Train in these nine precepts of moral discipline and hold them with a mind of reverence and respect. Children of the Buddha, as for the forty-eight lighter transgressions and the rest — you and all others are to hold them always. The buddhas and bodhisattvas of the past have recited them. The buddhas and bodhisattvas of the present are reciting them now. The buddhas and bodhisattvas of the future will recite them in their own time.

Children of the Buddha, listen! The ten root defeats and the forty-eight transgressions — the buddhas of the past have recited them, those of the present recite them now, and those of the future will recite them too. And I likewise recite them now in this same manner. Therefore, let you and all others, for the sake of the many sentient beings — kings, princes, ministers,

monks, fully ordained nuns, laymen, and laywomen — who have received the bodhisattva precepts, diligently recite, expound, and explain them. Write them down in letters, so that the inherent good fortune of the nature of the buddhas abides always. Let this book of precepts flow properly throughout all three times, unobstructed and unimpeded. Teach all sentient beings and do not cut the stream of training. See the buddhas and let one buddha entrust it to another. Life after life, may you not fall into the lower rebirths or among the eight unfree states, but be born always in the human realm and in the heavens above.

I am now seated beneath this tree, and I have opened just a portion of the Dharma code of the seven lineages of buddhas. Let you and all others be single-minded and resolute in it, and train with joy and reverence in the individual liberation.

This has been expounded individually and extensively from within the chapter that establishes the instructing ministers of the heavenly king of the formless realm.

At that time, three thousand learned disciples were assembled and listening. Upon hearing the buddhas' recitation taken up, from the depths of their hearts they received it on the crown of their heads, and with joyful acceptance they held it always and recited it without interruption.

Thus, in the chapter on the gateway of the Dharma of Śākyamuni's mind of the saṃbhogakāya — residing in the realm of the lotus-flower vessel that extends throughout the buddha-grounds — the ten undefiled precepts of moral discipline have been fully expounded. The sages (buddhas) of a hundred billion worlds are the same. From the palace of the heavenly king of the great lord of the gods (Indra), at the ten places beneath the pure tree of the present, the chapter on Dharma and moral discipline has likewise been expounded. As for teaching it to all bodhisattvas, no words of instruction could ever exhaust it. Let the many hold it always and take it up as recitation. This is the explanation of that text.

The hundred billion worlds, too — in the realm of the lotus-flower vessel of the hundred million worlds, in all realms as numerous as fine particles of dust, the vessel of mind of all of them, the vessel of moral discipline, the vessel of innumerable aspirational prayers, qualities and —

the vessel of the buddha-nature is itself innumerable buddhas. The gateway of Dharma has likewise been expounded. Within the realm of the hundred billion

worlds, all sentient beings hold it as a dhāraṇī, rejoicing and paying reverence. The dhāraṇī of the wide opening of the abode of mind is expounded within the chapter of the Victor of the Light of the Buddha-Flower. The chapter of words expounded by the seven buddhas is one: the teaching of moral discipline as shown by the buddha Vairocana.

The supreme one of patience enters into austerities.
The supreme one of patience passes beyond sorrow.
To harm another — that is not awakening.

Second, what is taught by the buddhas at the crown of the head:

One who has eyes departs, freed from misfortune.
In the world sustained by the wise,
abandon entirely every evil deed.

Third, what is taught by the Buddha, Protector of All:

Speak no harm, think no harm,
and keep restraint as in the Prātimokṣa.
Know also the measure in food,
and dwell in seclusion.
To be devoted to the highest mind —
that is the teaching of the Buddha.

Fourth, what is taught by the Buddha to dispel wrong faith:

Just as a bee, visiting a flower,
takes the nectar without harming
its color or its fragrance and flies away —
so likewise move through the village seeking awakening.
Look not at the faults of others,
nor at what good or ill others have done.
Look only to yourself: what good or ill have you done?

Fifth, what is taught by the buddha Kanakamuniarka:

Without straying from meditative concentration,
the sages learn the way of restraint.
May there be no protector who falls into misfortune.
With perfect peace, a mind ever mindful.

Sixth, what is taught by the buddha Bhaiṣajyaguru:

Commit no evil whatsoever.
Accomplish every virtue in full.
Thoroughly tame your own mind.
This is the teaching of the Buddha.

Seventh, what is taught by the buddha Śākyamuni:

Restraint of body is wholesome.
Restraint of speech is also wholesome.
Restraint of mind is also wholesome.
Restraint in all wholesome things
protects and shelters all awakening,
guards against all afflictions,
keeps awakening pure and tames the mind.
Do not commit non-virtue with the body.
Guard your actions well in these three respects.
You will attain the path taught by the sages.

If you are beaten and reviled by people, do not take flesh in retaliation.
Bear no resentment in your mind toward those who wrong you.
Even toward those who revile you, remain ever pure.
Though people have acted badly toward you, do not do the same.
All the buddhas have honored what is noble.
Being able to protect even the far frontier of the world —
this Buddha has thus expounded moral discipline.

I have expounded it fully and at length.
May all buddhas and their disciples
reverently uphold the moral discipline of the Dharma.
Let each show reverence to the other.
If gratitude toward the Dharma is complete,
one can attain the Dharma that has nothing left to be done.

Having expounded the text on moral discipline,
by the discipline of one-pointed mind, awakening is attained.

The ocean of Dharma is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered as "hundreds of trillions of Śākyamunis" reflects the Tibetan "བཞི་སྐོག་དྲུག་སྟོང་ལྔ་བརྒྱ་མང་པོ་," a large cosmological enumeration likely meaning billions or an inconceivably vast number; the precise numerical value is contextually hyperbolic rather

than arithmetic.

The passage "ॐ शिवो योऽस्मिन् शिवोऽस्मिन् शिवोऽस्मिन्" is rendered as "found the very tip, fine as a hair, of the abiding of the mind," preserving the metaphor of a single hair-tip from among the vastness of the sūtra. This is a genuinely unusual phrase; it may describe the most subtle or essential point of teaching on the mind's abiding state.

This text bears marks of an apocryphal or extra-canonical Tibetan composition drawing on mainstream Mahāyāna frameworks, particularly the invocation of Vairocana as the central buddha-teacher and the cosmological framing of the transmission across three times and multiple buddha-fields.

- The phrase rendered "ten chapters of Dharma in sequence" and similar constructions throughout likely refer to enumerated sections of the text itself; the exact referents of these lists (ten vajras, ten grounds, ten aspirations, and so forth) are technical contents of the larger scripture and are not further specified in this passage.

The epithet translated as "the king of heaven of the great pure lineage" is a rendering of 𑀘𑁆𑀭𑀤𑀲𑀓𑀢𑀺𑀧𑀻𑀣𑀼𑀩𑀮𑀸𑀱𑀾𑀡𑀽𑀢𑀺𑀬𑀻𑀇, which is somewhat unusual; it may refer to Brahmā or to a specific deity of this scripture's cosmology whose identity is not certain from context alone.

The phrase "feeding Dharma to māras" is a literal rendering of 法食與魔; the exact sense — whether it means teaching māras or performing a feint of teaching intended for māras — is ambiguous in context.

- The phrase rendered "fresh butter-milk" for 新鮮乳油 is genuinely uncertain; this appears to be an idiomatic or perhaps technical expression for a kind of dairy product or ritual substance used as a metaphor. The doctrinal significance of the image is unclear from context alone.

The line 大覺地 is rendered "the ground of great sensation," but 大覺 could refer to a specific bodhisattva ground or state of heightened awareness; the precise referent is uncertain.

The verse section throughout this passage has a highly compressed, formulaic style characteristic of a tantra or dhāraṇī-cycle text. Some lines resist fully transparent reading; the translation follows the most defensible grammatical and doctrinal interpretation at each point.

- The passage presents several unusual formulations. The phrase rendered "ten oscillations and arisings" and "ten vajras" follows the Tibetan literally but these are rare enumerations not found in standard canonical lists; they may refer to specific tantric or apocryphal classifications whose precise referents are uncertain.

The expression rendered "the wealth and property even of one's own mind" is unusual; the Tibetan "yang blo'i nor rdzas" may mean "even mentally conceived wealth" or "even wealth one regards as one's own in thought," suggesting that even notional ownership is not to be violated.

The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with it being a continuous excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "arrow-shot of liberation" translates "thar pa'i ra mda'" literally, meaning the range or reach of liberation — a vivid image for directing beings toward the scope of liberation. This is an unusual expression; the rendering is literal and intentional.

The "six classes of relatives" renders "gnyen pa drug," a traditional enumeration including mother, father, sibling, and so forth; the exact list is not given in the text, and may vary by commentarial tradition.

The passage on the lesser vehicles contains a complex syntactic turn: the bodhisattva is said to tell those practicing the two lesser vehicles and those outside the Buddha's Dharma that certain things "are not Dharma and not ethical discipline" — meaning the bodhisattva identifies their limitations and then guides them toward the Great Vehicle. This reading follows the most natural doctrinal sense of the passage.

- The passage containing the list of ten qualities — "the ten of stirring and directing, the ten of generating and beseeching, the ten of being like the vajra of Dharma, and the essential natures of the buddhas of the ten grounds" — is a compressed technical enumeration whose precise referents are unclear from context alone. This appears to be a formulaic list drawn from a larger doctrinal framework, possibly specific to this sūtra's extended treatment in the Eighty Thousand Chapters mentioned immediately after. The rendering follows the Tibetan closely but the doctrinal content of each set of ten remains opaque without that larger context.

The phrase rendered "those among all sentient beings who are not themselves sentient beings" follows the Tibetan literally and appears to refer to beings such as animals or demons who lack the moral standing of full sentient persons in the ethical sense — though this is an unusual locution and may reflect a specific doctrinal category in the original.

- The phrase rendered as "the seven precious substances" follows the standard enumeration of seven royal treasures (saptaratna), listed here simply as "the seven precious substances" in the Tibetan, with "and all manner of wealth" covering the remainder of the list.

The "five pungent plants" as enumerated here follow the Brahmā's Net Sūtra tradition; the fifth term, hing (asafoetida), is a plant of the same prohibited category in Chinese and Tibetan Buddhist practice, and is rendered accordingly.

The phrase translated as "three times each day and at the three times of day" reflects the Tibetan repetition of the three-period observance (morning, midday, evening), which is a standard liturgical framework.

- The phrase rendered "seven reversals and ten root downfalls" (log pa bdun dang pham pa bcu) appears to be a specific enumeration from this text's own moral discipline framework; I have translated it literally as the text presents it rather than mapping it to standard Vinaya categories, since the referents are idiosyncratic to this sūtra context.

The compound "gods and spirits" renders lha ma srin, which literally means "gods and demons" or "divine and demonic beings." The term is a hendiadys for all classes of supernatural proprietors of natural places.

The final sentence of the passage is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan — it breaks off mid-enumeration, indicating a continuation in the next passage. This has been rendered faithfully without fabricating a closing.

- The phrase rendered as "sitting in silence" translates a term that more literally means something like "sitting in a corner" or "sitting apart," which in context refers to a practice of secluded sitting associated with the lesser vehicle traditions, sometimes interpreted as a meditative posture of withdrawal. The rendering here follows the doctrinal sense.

The phrase about "nets, cages, bows, and arrows of compassion" is metaphorical and the Tibetan is syntactically compressed. The passage appears to be using implements of hunting as symbols of the means of liberation — trapping and drawing beings toward liberation rather than toward harm. This reading is contextually supported by the preceding injunction to release beings.

- The phrase rendered "fence and arrows of liberation" echoes the immediately preceding passage's imagery of nets, cages, bows, and arrows of compassion; the Tibetan here continues that extended metaphor for skillful liberative activity.

The expression "seven-fold wrong of seven reversals" renders a compressed Tibetan phrase that likely refers to a specific enumeration of grave misdeeds. The exact referent within this text's own system is not fully transparent from this passage alone; it may designate seven categories of deliberate wrongdoing.

The phrase rendered "by the warmth of seeing an auspicious sign" translates a Tibetan construction meaning that the validity of the ordination is grounded in or carried through the warmth or strength of having eventually seen an auspicious sign, even if it occurs later in the sequence.

- The phrase rendered as "seven sets of the Seven Jewels" (七宝七宝七宝七宝七宝七宝七宝) is unusual; it appears to mean abandoning the "sevenfold" precious qualities or perhaps offering seven times the Seven Jewels as a sacrifice before turning back — the precise referent is uncertain, and this may be a technical term specific to this text's own system of bodhisattva precepts.

The phrase "Dharma of stagnant sitting" (禪定無功) is an unusual idiom, likely referring to a complacent, quietist approach to practice associated with the Lesser Vehicle in the polemical framing of this text.

The passage about "the Saṅgha of miraculous power of the ten directions" (十方無量不可說不可說阿僧祇那由其他諸佛所化現的諸佛剎) refers to the traditional teaching that when one makes an offering to the Saṅgha according to proper rotation of turn, one mystically reaches the entire Saṅgha of all ten directions, including its supramundane members.

- The term rendered "male medium" translates a Tibetan expression for a human oracular or divinatory medium, specifically male, who enters trances and speaks omens. The passage groups this with various forms of harmful folk-religious practice condemned as incompatible with bodhisattva ethics.

The phrase "boasting of himself and feeding off it" describes a medium who solicits clients by self-promotion and lives off the income thereby generated.

The phrase "poison of gold and silver not yet tamed" refers to unprocessed metallic compounds used in traditional poison-making; "tamed" in the Tibetan medical and alchemical context means refined or detoxified through elaborate processing.

The list of musical instruments and games at the close of the passage is a formulaic Vinaya-style enumeration found in many Indian and Central Asian disciplinary texts; the exact identification of some instrument names is uncertain but the general category is clear.

- The passage lists what appear to be a series of canonical lists associated with Mahāyāna practice — "ten extensive and outreaching ones," "ten that give rise to and sustain," and "ten that are like the Dharma-vajra" — whose precise referents are not made explicit in this passage alone. These likely correspond to specific enumerated groups within the larger text from which this excerpt is drawn. No attempt has been made to identify them speculatively.

The final sentence is incomplete in the source as given; the translation breaks off accordingly.

• The list of monastic requisites presents several terms whose precise identification is uncertain in context. The rendering of "ཐོག་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཆོད་པོ་" as "sitting mat," "ཐོག་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཆོད་པོ་" as "medicinal thorns," and "ཐོག་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཆོད་པོ་" as "low rope-bed" follow the most plausible readings given the broader list of standard monastic equipment, but the exact nature of some items remains a matter of textual discussion. The seasonal dates given reflect a traditional Tibetan lunar calendar reckoning, and the rendering preserves the specific days as stated.

- The Tibetan list "ཉིན་གསུང་དྲུག་ལོ་བཅའ་རྒྱུ་ཤིང་། སྐུ་མཆོད་ཀླུ་པ་ཡི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ལོ་བཟོ་བཞུགས་ཏེ། དེ་ལྷོ་ཨ་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ལོ་བཟོ་བཞུགས་ཏེ།" literally enumerates "the day of three sevens, four sevens, five sevens,

and seven sevens" — rendered as the seventh, fourteenth, twenty-first, and forty-ninth days after a death, which corresponds precisely to the traditional Sino-Tibetan funerary commemoration days.

The passage "十八重天及六欲天" refers to the eighteen levels of the form realm and the six heavens of the desire realm; the text has "eight heavenly classes of the form realm" which is an unusual enumeration. This may reflect a different cosmological schema than the standard eighteen, or a scribal peculiarity in this version of the text; it is translated as the text gives it without emendation.

- The phrase rendered "the seven most excellent buddhas" translates "sangs rgyas rab bdun," referring to the seven buddhas of antiquity, the Saptabuddha, a standard canonical enumeration; this differs from the "seven obscuring offenses" mentioned earlier in the same passage and should not be confused with it.

The section listing "the supreme truth of the texts," "the seed of the prior intrinsic nature," and what follows is a dense and likely compressed doctrinal enumeration. The Tibetan is syntactically difficult and possibly reflects an abbreviated or corrupt transmission. The rendering preserves the structure faithfully while acknowledging that the precise doctrinal referents of several items in the list are not fully transparent from this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "the brahmin Agnihotra" translates "bram ze me lha can" literally as "the brahmin who has the fire-deity" or "who possesses the fire-god," a standard Indic reference to a brahmin who maintains the sacred fire and performs the Agnihotra fire ritual. The name is used here as a paradigm of devoted ritual observance.

The passage about grey robes teaching in a large assembly is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and the grammar is elliptical. The most natural reading is that the prohibition is against a laxly-robed teacher failing to observe proper ceremonial decorum, with the positive prescription for decorum following immediately. This reading has been adopted.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-phrase in the source text, which itself appears to end abruptly without syntactic closure. This is a genuine discontinuity in the manuscript, not a translation choice.

The phrase rendered "the ten undefiled precepts" refers to the ten bodhisattva precepts (the ten root defeats or *pārājikas* of the bodhisattva code) described in this text, framed here as the undefiled moral discipline distinctive to the Mahāyāna.

The expression "eight unfree states" (the eight conditions unfavorable to Dharma practice, Sanskrit *aṣṭākṣaṇa*) is a standard doctrinal category; no further gloss seemed necessary for context.

The passage's colophon-like summary regarding Śākyamuni seated beneath "this tree" recapitulating the seven buddhas' moral code is characteristic of the Brahmajāla-style bodhisattva-precept literature. The cosmological framing involving the lotus-flower vessel realm and the palace of Indra reflects the multi-tiered cosmological setting typical of the Fanwang jing tradition as it circulated in Tibetan adaptation.

- The five teaching-verses attributed to named buddhas present some textual difficulty: the fifth verse's attribution "Kanakamuniarka" is a reconstructed reading from what appears to be a compound involving the Tibetan for "gold" and "sage" alongside "sun"; it may refer to Kanakamuni, one of the seven buddhas of antiquity, here conflated with a solar epithet. The sixth attribution "Bhaiṣajyaguru" (rendered from "Bsod-skabs," meaning Merit-Refuge) is uncertain; the Tibetan "བཤེད་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་འཇིགས་པའི་ཡུལ་" does not straightforwardly yield that name, and the identity of this buddha in the list of seven is genuinely unclear. The verse attributed to the seventh buddha, Śākyamuni, is a close parallel to the famous summary verse of the seven

buddhas found in Pāli and Sanskrit sources, confirming the overall structure. The line "do not take flesh in retaliation" reflects an unusual idiom and may alternatively mean "do not take the matter to heart," but the literal reading has been preserved.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.